separate electorates. However, Jinnah signalled that he was willing to consider joint electorates if the Congress met his other demands. Clothed into concrete modifications to the Nehru Report during an 'All Parties Conference' in Calcutta, Jinnah pressed the committee members who were deciding on the merits of the Nehru Report that at least 'one-third of the elected representatives of both the Houses of the Central Legislature should be Mussalamans'.[29]

In a moving speech on the fifth day of the convention, Jinnah clarified that his desire was not to overwhelm the Congress with demands that would make it look soft on Muslims in front of the Hindu Mahasabha. Instead, Jinnah's demands were guided solely by dry constitutional observations from other countries. According to Jinnah, by the 1920s, it had become conventional wisdom that 'majorities are apt to be oppressive and tyrannical and minorities always dread and fear that their interests and rights, unless clearly and definitely safeguarded by statutory provisions, would suffer […].'[30] Jinnah reasoned that because the Nehru Report predicted that a third of the legislature would consist of Muslim delegates anyway, there would be no harm in implementing this figure as a formal constitutional safeguard. Such a written anchor would also allow Indian Muslims to distribute those seats more evenly and distribute the excess seats that they would receive in the Muslim-majority provinces of Bengal and Punjab to regions where Muslims were numerically weaker.[31]

The delegates roundly rejected Jinnah's proposal. Dissent to his suggestions even emerged from within the ranks of the Muslim League.[32] Other parties rejoiced over the open split in the Muslim League. M.R. Jayakar of the Hindu Mahasabha, for instance, poked right into this wound. In his response to Jinnah's speech, Jayakar cautioned the audience to 'bear in mind that the demands, as set forth by Mr Jinnah, do not proceed on behalf of the entire Muslim Community, not even a large bulk of it'. With some justification, Jayakar reiterated that the position Jinnah voiced reflected the desires of 'a small minority of Muhammadans'.[33] This speech left a mark on Jinnah. Responding to Jayakar, he moved away from his